Finnbot: Setup Instructions

The accounts and keys to get ready before you join, in order. (Estimated time: 30–45 minutes)

For detailed descriptions of each option and associated costs, please consult the **full guide** (Finnbot Guide For New Users).

Updated October 2026. Reach out to Andres at andres.cervera.rozo@gmail.com if you have any questions.

Which Steps Apply to You?

Goal / Workflow	Required Steps
Buying Ideas only (no holdings, Free)	Steps **1, 7, 8**
Holdings set manually in a Google Sheet	Steps **1–3, 5–9** (skip SnapTrade / Step 4)
Holdings linked automatically (via SnapTrade) **RECOMMENDED**	Every step except Step **5**

Note: Telegram setup (Step 3) is optional, but without it you will not receive intermediate alerts between scheduled emails.

1. Store Everything Safely, as You Go

Every login credential, API key, ID, and recovery code generated during setup must be stored somewhere secure at the user's discretion immediately upon receipt.

- **Important:** Many keys are displayed only once and cannot be retrieved later.

2. Anthropic (Claude) API Key

Purpose: Reviews and analyzes your holdings.

1. Navigate to the Anthropic Claude platform dashboard and create an account or sign in. *(Note: This is separate from a Claude Pro/Max subscription).*
2. Under **Billing**, add a payment card and purchase at least **$5 USD** of API credit. *(Recommended: Set a monthly spend limit).*

3. Under **API Keys**, select **Create Key**, name it `Finnbot`, and copy the generated key (starts with `sk-ant-`). Save it immediately somewhere secure.

3. Telegram Setup (Optional)

Purpose: Receive instant market and portfolio alerts on your mobile device.

1. Install the **Telegram** app on your smartphone and register an account.
2. Search for **@Finn31_bot** (Finn), open the chat, and press **Start**. *(The bot cannot message you until initiated).*
3. Retrieve your Chat ID by sending a message to **@userinfobot**. Copy the numeric response (e.g., `123456789`) and save it.

4. SnapTrade Setup

Purpose: Automate brokerage linking (only if tracking holdings automatically).

1. Sign up on the SnapTrade dashboard (Personal plan is free).
2. Enable **Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)**, which is required by SnapTrade to issue API credentials.
3. Connect your brokerage account via the provided window. Select **read-only access** if prompted—Finnbot never executes trades.
4. Open the API Key settings page and generate a key. Copy both your **Client ID** and **Consumer Key**.
5. Save any recovery codes provided by SnapTrade somewhere secure. Not required for Finnbot.

5. Google Sheets Setup

Purpose: Manual holdings tracking (skip if using SnapTrade or Ideas Only).

1. Create a new Google Sheet (link creates one automatically, move to desired folder afterwards).
2. On the first tab, enter the exact column headers in Row 1 (lowercase, with underscores):

Column Header	Required	Description / Format
`symbol`	Yes	Ticker symbol as formatted on Yahoo Finance (e.g., `AAPL`, `SHOP.TO`)

Column Header	Required	Description / Format
`shares_qty`	Yes	Total quantity of shares held (decimals/fractions allowed)
`avg_purchase_price`	Yes	Average cost basis per share, in the stock's native trading currency
`account_name`	Yes	Account classification (e.g., `TFSA`, `RRSP`, `Margin`)
`currency`	No	Trading currency (detected automatically by default)

Note: Any additional columns (e.g., notes) will be ignored.

3. **Share Access:** Click **Share**, add Finnbot's service account email: `finnbot-service@finnbot-504921.iam.gserviceaccount.com`, grant **Viewer** permissions, uncheck **Notify people**, and confirm.
4. **Extract Sheet ID:** Find the sheet's ID: the long code in its web address, between `/d/` and `/edit`. For example, in: `https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/**1AbCdEfGhIjKlMnOpQrStUvWxYz0123456789**/edit#gid=0` the ID is `**1AbCdEfGhIjKlMnOpQrStUvWxYz0123456789**`. The ID alone opens nothing, but is required for Google Sheets setup.

6. Gemini API Key

Purpose: fetches the latest news for your holdings (optional; skip this step if you turn news off).

1. Go to the Google AI Studio API Keys page (aistudio.google.com/api-keys) and sign in with your Google account.
2. Click **Create API Key** (let it create a project if asked) and copy the key (it starts with AIza).
3. Turn on billing for the key's project: go to console.cloud.google.com, open Billing, and attach a payment card. This step is required, because Google's free tier doesn't include the web search Finnbot uses to find news, so a key without billing gets no news at all.
4. **Recommended**: in Billing, set a budget alert so you're emailed if costs ever rise.
5. Save the key somewhere secure.

Note: news costs about $0.27 a month for 10 holdings, or $0.53 for 20, with both digests. Each key also includes 5,000 free web searches a month, far more than Finnbot uses, so you only pay for the text the model writes.

7. Gmail Configuration

Purpose: Enables interactive dynamic dropdowns in email digests.

1. Open Gmail in a web browser on desktop view using the recipient Gmail account (or desktop view on mobile phone).
2. Click **Settings (gear icon)** > **See all settings**.
3. Under the **General** tab, check **Enable dynamic email**.
4. In **Developer settings**, authorize `finnbot107@gmail.com` and select **OK**.
5. Click **Save Changes** at the bottom of the page.
6. Install and log into the mobile Gmail app for optimal digest formatting.

8. Complete the Sign-Up Form

Use the registration link provided by Andres to enter your name, recipient email, desired digest frequency, and preferences.

Security Notice: Never input API keys or passwords directly into the sign-up form.

9. Securely Submit Credentials

Send your configured credentials directly to Andres via one-to-one secure channel (check off applicable items):

- Anthropic API Key (Step 2)
- Telegram Chat ID (Step 3)
- SnapTrade Client ID & Consumer Key (Step 4)
- Google Sheet ID (Step 5)
- Gemini API Key (Step 6)

Security Guideline: Send credentials ONLY through a private direct message. Never share keys via regular email, group chat, shared documents, or screenshots. Delete your transmission message once receipt is confirmed.

What Happens Next

- Once your credentials and preferences are registered, processing starts at the next hourly setup check.

- You will receive your initial digest during the next scheduled delivery window (**7:00 AM** or **4:10 PM ET** on market trading days).
- If an API key expires or fails, notification banners will display at the top of your digest while continuing to deliver remaining sections.

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